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AI



Zuckerberg says people without AI glasses will be at a disadvantage in the future



Echoing sentiments shared in his [“superintelligence”-focused blog post](#) this morning, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg expanded on his bullish ideas that glasses will be the primary way users interact with AI in the years ahead. During Meta’s second-quarter earnings call, the social networking exec told investors he believes people without AI glasses will be at a disadvantage in the future.

“I continue to think that glasses are basically going to be the ideal form factor for AI, because you can let an AI see what you see throughout the day, hear what you hear, [and] talk to you,” Zuckerberg said during the earnings call. Adding a display to those glasses will then unlock more value, he said, whether that’s a wider, holographic field of view, as with [Meta’s next-gen Orion AR glasses](#), or a smaller display that might ship in everyday AI eyewear.

IMAGE CREDITS: META

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“I think in the future, if you don’t have glasses that have AI — or some way to interact with AI — I think you’re ... probably [going to] be at a pretty significant cognitive disadvantage compared to other people,” Zuckerberg added.

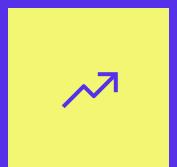
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Meta has been focused on building smart glasses, like its [Ray-Ban Meta glasses](#) and, more recently, [Oakley Meta glasses](#). The glasses let users listen to music, take photos or videos, and ask Meta AI questions, including about what they're seeing, among other things. These wearables have turned into a surprise hit for the company, as revenue from sales of the Ray-Ban Metas [more than tripled year-over-year](#), according to glasses giant EssilorLuxottica.

But Zuckerberg believes there's more to be done with displays.

"This is ... what we've been maxing out with Reality Labs over the last 5 to 10 years — basically doing the research on all these different things," he said.

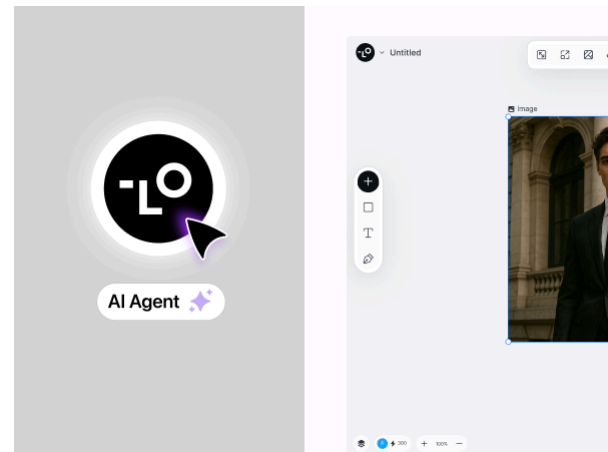
The Reality Labs division has been a money pit for the company, so it's not surprising the exec wants to justify its cost to investors by positioning it as a bet on the future of AI and consumer computing in general. For example, Meta said Reality Labs' [operating loss was \\$4.53 billion](#) in the second quarter. Since 2020, the unit has lost [nearly \\$70 billion](#).

However, the future of consumer AI may or may not be in the form of glasses. This spring, OpenAI acquired former Apple executive [Jony Ive's startup in a \\$6.5 billion deal](#) to build new consumer devices for interacting with AI. Already, other startups have dabbled in this area as well, including in form factors like AI pins — [such as with Humane's flop](#) — and pendants, like those from [Limitless](#) and [Friend](#).

Glasses, for now, seem to make the most sense, as many people already wear them, and they're more socially acceptable. But the world didn't know it needed smartphones, either, until someone dreamed them up. The next AI device could be something we can't even imagine yet.

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Still, Zuckerberg cheers the idea that glasses are going to be it.

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“The other thing that’s awesome about glasses is they are going to be the ideal way to blend the physical and digital worlds together,” he said. “So the whole Metaverse vision, I think, is going to ... end up being extremely important, too, and AI is going to accelerate that.”

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Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez — 12:45 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

Numerous studies indicate that the [shift to AI search features](#) and the use of [AI chatbots](#) are killing traffic to publishers' sites. But Google on Wednesday denied that's the case, at least in aggregate. Instead, the search giant says that total organic click volume from its search engine to websites has been "relatively stable" year-over-year and that average click quality has slightly increased.

"This data is in contrast to third-party reports that inaccurately suggest dramatic declines in aggregate traffic — often based on flawed methodologies, isolated examples, or traffic changes that occurred prior to the roll out of AI features in Search," writes Google VP and Head of Search, Liz Reid, in [a new blog post](#).

Though Google hasn't shared any specific data to back up its conclusions, even if we assume Google's claims to be true, this doesn't necessarily mean that AI isn't having an impact.

IMAGE CREDIT: JOSE LUIS CABRASCOSA / GETTY IMAGES

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Even Google has to admit this, as Reid acknowledges that “user trends are shifting traffic to different sites, resulting in decreased traffic to some sites and increased traffic to others.”

That word “some” is doing heavy lifting here, as Google doesn’t share data about how many sites are gaining or losing. And while chatbots like ChatGPT have certainly seen traffic increase in recent months, that doesn’t mean online publishers aren’t suffering.



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Google has been revamping its search engine for years to answer more questions directly on the search results page, and now does so with AI through its “AI Overviews” that appear at the top of search results. Google also allows users to interact with an AI chatbot for some queries. Yet Google denies that this is significantly reshaping the search landscape. Rather, it points to users shifting their attention to other sites to start their queries.

Reid explains, “People are increasingly seeking out and clicking on sites with forums, videos, podcasts, and posts where they can hear authentic voices and first-hand perspectives.”

Reading between the lines, it seems like Google.com isn’t necessarily people’s first stop on the web these days. (Google denies this, telling us that Reid’s commentary is only reflective of trends it’s seeing in traffic to sites from Google.)

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However, we’ve seen this trend for some time. Back in 2022, a Google exec even said that social sites like TikTok and Instagram [were eating into Google’s core products](#), like Search and Maps.

“In our studies, something like almost 40% of young people, when they’re looking for a place for lunch, they don’t go to Google Maps or Search,” said Google SVP Prabhakar Raghavan, who ran the company’s Knowledge and Information organization at the time (he is now its chief technologist). “They go to TikTok or Instagram,” he noted.

Google has also long been worried that Amazon.com had become people’s first stop for online shopping searches, and Reddit.com had become the first stop for researching topics of interest.

Over many years, the company has tried to come up with compelling features for both consumers and retailers that would attract more users to Google Shopping. These efforts have included [universal shopping carts](#), [local inventory checks](#), [deal finders](#), [shopping from product images on](#)

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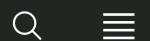




IMAGE CREDITS: SMITH COLLECTION/GADO / GETTY IMAGES

Google's new blog post also attempts to move the goalposts a bit about what it means for websites receiving Google's clicks. Now, instead of counting clicks, it wants publishers to think about click quality.

The company says average click quality has increased, and Google is sending "slightly more quality clicks" to websites than a year ago. (Google explains that a quality click is one where users don't quickly click back — they stay and read.) How much of an increase, though, Google doesn't say. The company only points out that when people click through on an AI response to the source, they're more likely to dive deeper, so those clicks are more valuable.

What's more, Google paints AI as an opportunity for web publishers to gain increased exposure, saying that "with AI Overviews, people are seeing more links on the page than before," Reid writes. "More queries and more links mean more opportunities for websites to surface and get clicked."

But AI, [while a growing referral source](#), isn't [yet making up the difference](#) in terms of clicks, reports have shown. One recent study from Similarweb indicates that the number of news searches on the web resulting in zero clicks to news websites has

grown from 56% (when Google launched AI Overviews in May 2024) to 69% as of May 2025.



IMAGE CREDITS:SIMILARWEB

Google appears to know this is a trend, too, as it recently launched [a product for publishers](#) that helps them monetize their dwindling traffic in other ways that don't rely only on advertising, like micropayments or newsletter sign-ups.

The fact that Google is pushing this “AI is not the end of search traffic!” PR now only makes the situation seem more dire. It's as if Google wants publishers to believe not what their own eyes — and graphs and charts — tell them, but instead take comfort in the fact that Google still sends “billions of clicks to websites” every day, just as the post claims.

Updated after publication with a comment from Google.

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AI agents aren't the 'new Google,' says Airbnb CEO

After a second-quarter earnings **beat**, Airbnb CEO Brian Chesky shared his thoughts on the company's AI strategy, cautioning investors that AI chatbots can't yet be thought of as the "new Google." That is, AI chatbots, while potentially driving new leads to the travel and services business, aren't entirely a replacement for the referrals that the dominant search engine brings.

At least not at this time.

"I think we're still kind of feeling out the space," the exec told investors on the Q2 earnings call. "The thing I want to caution is I don't think that AI agents — I don't think we should think of chatbots like Google — I don't think we should think of them as the 'new Google' yet."

This, Chesky explained, is because AI models aren't "proprietary."

"We also have to remember that the model powering ChatGPT is not proprietary. It's not exclusive to ChatGPT. We — Airbnb — can also use the API, and there are other models that we can use," he said.

Painting a broader picture of the AI landscape, Chesky said that in addition to chatbots and other AI agents, there will be custom-built startups designed for specific applications, as well as other incumbents that have made the shift to AI.

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“One of the things we’ve noticed is it’s not enough to just have ... the best model. You have to be able to tune the model and build a custom interface for the right application. And I think that’s the key,” he said.

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The company told investors it will look to take advantage of AI in a number of ways.

Airbnb shared during the call that its AI customer service agent in the U.S. reduced the percentage of

guests contacting a human agent by 15%, for instance. This was actually harder than tackling the lower-hanging fruit involving travel planning and inspiration, Chesky said, because AI agents performing customer service can't hallucinate. They have to be accurate and helpful at all times.

Airbnb's customer service agent was built using 13 different models and trained on tens of thousands of conversations, and is currently available in English in the U.S. This year, Airbnb will roll it out to more languages, and next year, it will become more personalized and agentic. That means it would be able to understand if someone reaches out to cancel a reservation; not only would it be able to tell them how to do so, but it could also do it for them. The agent could also help plan and book trips.

Plus, AI will come to Airbnb's search next year, the CEO said.

However, the company has not fully fleshed out its plans for working with third-party AI agents, although it's considering it. Users still need an Airbnb account to make a booking.

Because of this, Chesky doesn't think agentic AI would turn its business into a commodity, the way that booking flights has become. Instead, he sees AI as "potentially interesting lead generation" for the company.

"I think the key thing is going to be for us to lead and become the first place for people to book travel on Airbnb. As far as whether or not we integrate with AI agents, I think that's something that we're certainly open to," he said.

Airbnb beat analysts' expectations in the quarter with revenue of \$3.1 billion and earnings per share of \$1.03, but the stock [dropped](#) on its forecast of slower growth in the second half of the year.



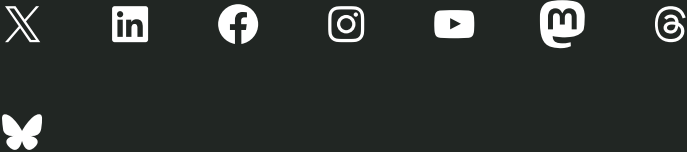
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